



**UNIVERSITY
OF LONDON**

Information Security Policy (ISP-001)

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Team	Data Protection and Information Compliance
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University of London Information Security Policy

The University of London recognises that Information is fundamental to the successful delivery of its strategic objectives and, next to people, is its most important asset.

This Information Security Policy is designed to ensure that information is appropriately secured in order to protect against the consequences of breaches of confidentiality, failures of integrity or interruptions to availability. Failure to adequately secure information increases the risk of significant operational, financial, regulatory and reputational impacts to the University.

This overarching policy document provides management direction and support for information security and lists a set of component sub-policy documents which taken together constitute the Information Security Policy of the University.

Contents

1. What is the purpose of the Information Security Policy?
2. What is the University's Policy on Information Security?
3. Who and what does this policy apply to?
4. Who is responsible for Information Security?
5. What are the sub-policies of the Information Security Policy?
6. What legislation and internal policies are relevant to the Information Security Policy?

1. What is the purpose of the Information Security Policy?

- 1.1 Ensure that all information and information systems within the University are protected to the appropriate level, in line with all relevant University policies and legislation.
- 1.2 Ensure that information is made available solely to those who have a legitimate need for access.
- 1.3 Provide a safe and secure information systems environment for staff, students and any other authorised users.
- 1.4 Protect the University from liability or damage through the misuse of information or information systems.
- 1.5 Ensure that all users are aware of and comply with this policy, related policies and all relevant UK legislation.
- 1.6 Ensure that all users understand their own responsibilities for protecting the confidentiality, integrity and availability of the data that they handle.
- 1.7 Ensure that all breaches of security are reported and managed in line with all relevant University policies and legislation.
- 1.8 Demonstrate Senior Management commitment to information security and set out the roles and responsibilities across the organisation to protect information and information systems.

2. What is the University's Policy on Information Security?

Information Classification

- 2.1 All organisational information must be classified and protected according to its level of risk, using one of the following categories: Highly Confidential, Confidential, General, Public or Non-Business, as defined in the University's Data Classification Policy.

Security Controls

- 2.2 Information systems must be configured with all appropriate security controls applied, in accordance with the Systems Management Policy.
- 2.3 Access controls must be configured in accordance with the User Account Management Policy.

Availability

- 2.4 Backup and Disaster Recovery Plans must be in place to mitigate the risk of loss of data and/or interruption to prioritised activities in accordance with the Business Continuity and Incident Management Policy.

Monitoring

- 2.5 The University undertakes some routine monitoring of activity on its information systems to ensure that they operate correctly and to protect against the risk of harm from viruses, malicious attack and other known threats. This does not normally involve the monitoring of individual communications or the disclosure of the contents of any user files.
- 2.6 The University reserves the right to monitor the use of its information systems, including emails sent and received, and web pages or other online content accessed, in accordance with the Regulation of Investigatory Powers Act 2000 (RIPA). Such monitoring will only be carried out if authorised by the relevant senior University staff, as defined in the Acceptable Use Policy.

Breaches of Security

- 2.7 Any individual suspecting that the security of a computer system has been, or is likely to be, breached must inform IT Security immediately.
- 2.8 In the event of a suspected or actual breach of information security, IT Security, with or without consultation with the relevant department, may require that any systems or user accounts suspected of being compromised are made inaccessible.
- 2.9 IT Security will maintain and regularly test the Incident Response Plan, in accordance with the Business Continuity and Incident Management Policy
- 2.10 Where a breach of security involving either computer or paper records relates to personal information, the University Data Protection Officer must be informed, to ensure that the University's obligations under the Data Protection Act 2018 can be met.
- 2.11 All suspected or actual physical security breaches should be reported to the University's Security Office.

Awareness and Enforcement

- 2.12 All users of the University's information systems will be advised of the existence of this policy, which will be made available on the University website.

- 2.13 All users are required to familiarise themselves with this policy and comply with its requirements.
- 2.14 University of London Staff are required to complete mandatory Information Security Training within one month of employment and thereafter at least every 2 years.
- 2.15 Failure to comply with this policy may result in the withdrawal of access to information systems, lead to the instigation of disciplinary procedures and, in certain circumstances, reporting to the police and/or legal action may be taken.

3. Who and what does this policy apply to?

- 3.1 This Information Security Policy applies to all staff, students and other members of the University and third parties who interact with information held by the University and the information systems used to store and process it, collectively termed 'users' throughout this document.
- 3.2 For the purposes of this document, the University is defined as the central academic and administrative departments of the University of London; including CoSector, University of London Worldwide, The School of Advanced Study and The University of London in Paris.
- 3.3 This Policy applies to information in all its forms. It covers information stored digitally, on paper or other media, information transmitted by post, by electronic means and by oral communication, including telephone and voicemail. It includes text, pictures, audio, video and any data consumed by Large Language Models (LLMs) for the purposes of Artificial Intelligence. It applies throughout the lifecycle of the information from creation through storage and utilisation to disposal. Appropriate protection is required for all forms of information to ensure business continuity and to avoid breaches of the law and statutory, regulatory or contractual obligations.
- 3.4 Information Security is commonly defined as the preservation of:
- Confidentiality (protecting information from unauthorised access and disclosure)
 - Integrity (safeguarding the accuracy and completeness of information)
 - Availability (ensuring that information and associated services are available to authorised users when required)

4. Who is responsible for what?

- 4.1 It is the responsibility of all users to be aware of and comply with this policy, related policies and all current and relevant UK legislation.
- 4.2 The Information Technology and Digital Services (ITDS) Department is responsible for the creation, maintenance and monitoring of this policy and sub-policies.
- 4.3 The Information Technology and Digital Services (ITDS) Department is responsible for operational security and the coordination of response to breaches of security.
- 4.4 This top-level policy document has been approved by the Vice-Chancellor's Executive Group (VCEG). Responsibility for the approval of all sub-policy documents is delegated to the IT Strategy & Architecture Group.
- 4.5 Each of the documents constituting the Information Security Policy will be reviewed annually.

5. What are the sub-policies of the Information Security Policy?

Policy Name	ID	Status
Information Security	ISP-001	Live
Acceptable Use	ISP-002	Live
Patch Management	ISP-003	Live
Disaster Recovery	ISP-004	In progress
Cyber Incident Management	ISP-005	In progress
User Account Management	ISP-006	In progress
Bring your own device (BYOD)	ISP-007	Live
Systems Management	ISP-008	In Progress
Network Management	ISP-009	In progress
Privileged Account Management	ISP-010	Live

6. What legislation and internal policies are relevant to the Information Security Policy?

6.1 The use of information is governed by a number of different Acts of Parliament. All users have an obligation to comply with current relevant legislation which includes, but is not limited to:

- Computer Misuse Act (1990)
- The Data Protection Act (2018)
- Freedom of Information Act (2000)
- Copyright, Designs and Patents Act (1988)
- Regulation of Investigatory Powers Act (2000)
- Human Rights Act (1998)
- Electronic Communications Act (2000)
- Digital Economy Act (2010)
- Obscene Publications Act (1959 & 1964)
- Counter-Terrorism and Security Act (2015)

6.2 The following University of London Policies are related to and support this policy:

- Data Protection Policy
- Data Classification Policy
- Records Management Policy
- Risk Management Policy
- Business Continuity and Incident Management Policy
- Artificial Intelligence Policy
- Research Data Management Policy